

Time to spend

We're used to consuming free software and services and have taken many of these for granted. However, we also do have a responsibility in sustaining several of these noble services

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It is difficult, if not impossible, for anyone to take a comprehensive conspectus of Internet, for the simple reason that the web-space continues to expand at an unimaginably explosive pace. Internet has percolated into every segment of life, making it imperative for us to be Internet savvy or risk being out of tune with latest happenings and trends. Our list of bookmarks keeps growing, as we discover new places and new software tools on the web that have the potential to enhance the quality of our lives. An unprecedented amount of information and services is available for free at the click of a mouse.

Many of these web-based entities consciously avoid the advertisement route for funding of their operations. They prefer to depend on donations. The message you get is that the focus is not on raking dollops of cash, but in providing genuine service. Maybe we should start donating as a gesture of support for the Good Samaritans, who are behind the free software and websites. In most cases, making donations is easy; you can transfer funds online in a secure manner. Of course, you are not obliged to make a donation, but if you do, then you garner the satisfaction of rewarding someone's good work.

What follows is an overview of web-sites and software that are not supported by any kind of fees or advertisements; their only source of revenue is donations.

Donationware

Spybot www.safer-networking.org/en/index.html

A malware attack is every PC user's worst nightmare. But many of us are often forced to forgo the protection, because anti-virus systems cost a bomb. However, now there is an alternative for users who wish to save their hard earned money, while doing something to protect their system from sudden attacks. The alternative is Spybot, a free and efficient tool to protect your PC. No one is obliged to give anything to Spybot; however, you can contribute to the cause by making small donations. This is how a punch line on the Spybot's home page goes, "If you don't feel like donating for software, think of it as buying us a drink!" If anything, you have to give these guys a credit not just for creating world-class software, but also for their superb sense of humour.

Socso

sockso.pu-gh.com

If you are deeply into music, then it is time you had your own music server. Enter Socso - the free Java based application, which will create a home music server for you in a matter of few steps only. After that your PC will become the medium through which music can be streamed, so that others around the world can happily tune in by using myriad web based technologies. The system can also prove beneficial when you have too many computer systems working at your home or office - you can have all the music files stored in one computer, while the other PCs and laptops can connect to it,



whenever they need to groove to a tune. That way you end up saving valuable disc space. The system will support music files of these types - MP3, OGG Vorbis, Flac and WMA.

Zemanta

www.zemanta.com

For many of us blogging has now become a way of life. But coming up with coherent, informative posts, which



are embellished with pertinent images and links, can turn out to be a cumbersome chore. How about having your own assistant to help you with your blogging activities! What you are looking for goes by the name of, Zemanta. This wonderful software is compatible with some of world's most popular blogging platforms, including Wordpress, Flickr, etc. Once you have installed it, as a plug-in to your favourite browser, Zemanta will work quietly in the background to ensure that you get easy access to relevant information pertaining to the blog post you are creating. Even if the software is for free, you can always pitch in with a donation.

Scratch

scratch.mit.edu

How about trying to create some animated cartoons, small video games or other